

Last laugh: Dimitri Petratos (left, centre) scored the only goal of the match in added time. Mohun Bagan broke many records on the way to its title, including securing six successive clean sheets among a total of 14. It also scored the highest number of goals (43) and conceded the fewest (14) on its way to the title. FSDL

of invincibility with two matches to spare (second-placed FC Goa, which has 42 from 21, could reach a maximum of 51 if it wins its remaining three matches). What made Mohun Bagan's achievement even bigger was the fact that it had the highest accumulation of points in the history of the ISL.

The title marked the fruition of intelligent planning and effective implementation. This was evident in the team's authoritative performance as Mohun Bagan accomplished 16 wins, four draws, and suffered just two losses in its successful pursuit of the title.

The team broke many records, including securing six successive clean sheets among a total of 14. Another factor aiding its success was creating the ideal balance of attack and defence, reflected in the fact that Mohun Bagan scored the highest number of goals (43) and conceded the fewest (14) on its way to the title.

And in the title count, The Mariners also established themselves as one of the best performers in the ISL by winning a trophy in three successive seasons. Mohun Bagan won the ISL Cup in the 2022-23 season before picking up the League Shield in the next two, reaching a level of unmatched consistency. Mumbai City FC has won the League Shield and the Cup on two occasions each, placing it one up in terms of the total number of trophies, but Mohun Bagan outscores it in terms of consistency.

"To win a trophy, you need to be a team. And it is not about having 11 players but a group of players. A title is realised when everybody is working in the same direction. The support of the owner and management is really important. So is the contribution of

the coaching staff, the supporting staff and, of course, the quality and hard work of the players," Molina said when he was asked about the recipe for success.

Molina arrived with great credentials, having served as the sporting director of the Spanish football federation, and he proved his worth by shepherding Mohun Bagan to the title.

"Every title, for us as a player and as a coach, is special. You start with dreams at the beginning of the season, and it feels really good when your plans and hard work bring results at the end of the season. Our goal is to make the fans happy, and today they are the happiest fans in the world. I am happy for all the support they have given us through the league," Molina added.

This reaffirmed Molina's special

Hunger for trophies: Mohun Bagan established themselves as one of the best performers in the ISL by winning a trophy in three successive seasons — the ISL Cup in the 2022-23 season and the League Shield in the next two. FSDL

bond with Kolkata, as he had helped ATK (the previous name of the franchise before it merged with Mohun Bagan in 2020) win the ISL Cup in 2016. "Winning a title gives me a sense of fulfilment. So, both titles are important in my career," Molina said while setting his sights on the next target — winning the 2025 ISL Cup.

One for the fans: Some 60,000 home fans went into raptures at the Salt Lake Stadium after seeing their team accomplish this mammoth feat. FSDL

